The prayer was over. Men embraced each other. They descended on the sweet and toy-vendors' stores like an army moving to attack. There was the merry-go-round with wooden elephants, horses and camels! You paid one paisa and had twenty-five rounds of fun. Mahmood and Mohsin and Noorey and other boys mounted the horses and camels.

Hamid watched them from a distance. All he had were three paisas. He couldn't part with a third of his treasure for a few miserable rounds! They were soon done with their rides. Then it was time for the toys. There was a row of stalls on one side with all kinds of toys; soldiers and milkmaids, kings and ministers, water-carriers and washer-women and holy men.

Mahmood bought a policeman in khaki with a red turban on his head and a gun on his shoulder. Mohsin bought a water-carrier while Noorey got a lawyer. Those toys cost two paisa each. Hamid had only three paisas. How could he buy such expensive toys? If they dropped out of his hand, they would be smashed to bits. If a drop of water fell on them, the colour would run. But he looked at them hungrily and wished he could hold them in his hands for just a moment or two. After the toys it was sweets. Someone bought sesame seed candy, others gulab-jamuns or halva. They **smacked** their lips with **relish**. Only Hamid was left out.

GLOSSARY		
gaped	–	stared
smack your lips	–	open and close lips noisily to show enjoyment
relished	–	enjoyed or took pleasure in the taste

Work in pairs and answer the following questions.

There were many toys in the stall. Three of Hamid's friends had bought some toys.

1. Write the names of Hamid's friends in column A and the toys they bought in column B

A	B

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